

Chapter – 9: From the Rulers to the Ruled: Types of Governments

A ruler's duties in the internal administration of the country are three-fold: Raksha (protection of the state from external aggression), pālana (maintenance of law and order within the state), and yogakṣhema (safeguarding the welfare of the people). – Kauṭilya in Arthaśāstra (translation by L.N. Rangarajan)

What is Govt.? What are its Func.?

- Grade 6 – learnt – what is govt. – explored roles
- Govt. – imp. roles – our lives –
 - Maintain – law, order – society
 - Ensure – peace, stability, security – people
 - Manage relations – other countries
 - Taking care – national defence
 - Deliver – essential goods, services – education, healthcare, infrastructure
 - Manage economy – economic act.
 - Work – welfare – improve people's lives
- Grade 6 – learnt – India – democratic govt. – many other countries as well
- Some countries – other forms – govt.
- All forms – democracy – not same

What is Democracy?

- Democracy – best understood – rule of the people – src. of power, authority – people of country

A school example

- School – act., things – must be done – day-to-day – tasks – managed, organized
- Example – time table to be made – sports act. to be organized – food served during lunch – etc.
- Too much to do – head teacher – appointed school committee – students – make rules, implement them, ensure they are followed
- Head teacher – discussed in assembly – proposed – some students – take responsibility
- Hearing this – students – excited – started arguing
 - Nagma – std. – grade 12 – most senior – take care – everything
 - Shobha – you will finish school – few months – grade 11 – take care – everything
 - Gurpreet – std. – single grade – take care – everything – how to understand – problems – other grades
- Std. – decided – 3 options –
 - Everyone – school – become part – committee – take responsibility
 - Head teacher – choose std.
 - Std. – choose representative – voting – chosen people – become member – committee
- 1st method – appealing – BUT – every std. – part of committee – difficult – reach decisions – manage implementations
- 2nd method – head teacher – select std. – many std. – no roles – no ways to ensure – voices heard
- 3rd method – std. – each grade – choose one person – advocate class's needs
- This person – serve on committee – meaning – std. committee – representative – each grade

- This approach democratic way – choose representative – form committee

Functions of Govt.

- Previously – discussed – various roles – govt. plays – similar – responsibilities of std. committee
- Like school committee – govt. – make rules, implement them, ensure people follow them
- 3 responsibilities – func. of govt. –
 - Creation of rules – **legislative func.** – these rules – framework – running country
 - Implementing rules – administrating country – **executive func.**
 - Ensuring – rules followed – **judicial func.**
- Democracy – rule of the people – similar to school committee – people select representative – govern them
- Every country – diff. methods – choose representative

What Makes Govt. Different?

- Govt. – any country – evolve – all the time
- Countries – own history, culture, aspirations – diff. countries – diff. govt.
- Some aspects – make one form – diff. from others – differences – clearer – later

Key differences between governments

- Who decides – this is govt.?
 - Most basic diff. – many types – govt. – who, what – gives authority, power
 - Democracy – India – people – decide authority
 - Theocracy – src. of authority – religious beliefs, head of religious institution
- How is the govt. formed?
 - Democracy – govt. – some kind – election
 - Kingdoms – kings, queens – someone – within family – rules – src. – govt.
 - Other ways – also there – within democracy – diff. kinds – election
- Diff. parts of govt. – what do they do?
 - Any govt. – many parts, sys. – vary across govt.
 - 3 func. of govt. – legislative, executive, judiciary – totally independent bodies – OR – same body
 - Sys. – decide – govt. works – written down – book – fundamental rules – constitution – most democracies
 - Rules – decided by – kings, queens – monarchies
- What is govt. working for? What goals it is trying to achieve?
 - Govt. – designed – work toward – values, ideals
 - Some govt. – India – designed to work – equality, prosperity – everyone
 - Other govt. – designed – prosperity – some family, groups
- Diff. govt. – many differences – based on 4 aspects – BUT – other differences also there

Democratic Govt. around the World

- Democracy – most popular form – modern world
- Any democracy – some fundamental principles – must know

Fundamental principles of democracy

- **Equality** – every person – treated equally – equal access – facilities – education, health – everyone equal before law
- **Freedom** – citizens – right – make own choices – express opinions
- **Representative participation** – every person – right – choose, elect – representatives – election – elected persons – part of legislature
- **Universal adult franchise** – every citizen – above 18 yrs. – right to vote – choose representative
- **Fundamental rights** – diff. rights – right to equality, right to freedom of speech, rights against exploitation – provided, protected
- **Independent judiciary** – ensure – every citizen's rights – protected – laws followed – citizens, parts of govt.
- Useful – remember – fundamental principles – evolved
- India – universal adult franchise – very beginning – Indian republic – 1950 – BUT – Switzerland – women – right to vote – 1971
- Above principles – ideals – all democracies – not in practice

Diff. forms of democratic govt.

- Direct democracy
 - This form – all citizens – directly responsible – rules, regulations, func. – participate – all decisions – directly
 - Modern times – this form – some countries – Switzerland
 - Limitation – very hard – carry out – specially – larger countries – everyone – part of committee – decision-making – difficult
- Representative democracy
 - This form – people elect – representative – universal adult franchise – India
 - People – don't govern directly – BUT – govt. – always responsible to people
- Elections – integral part – representative democracy – people – express changes – their choices
- Accomplish this – elections – regular, fixed intervals
- India – general elections – every 5 yrs. – USA – every 4 yrs.
- Most democracies – representative – BUT – every democracy – diff.
- Parliamentary democracy
 - This form – members of executive – part of legislature
 - India – prime minister, council of ministers – members of parliament
 - Council of ministers – accountable – legislature – work until – confidence of legislature
 - India – council of ministers – work until – confidence of Lok Sabha
 - This form – govt. – people elect legislature – not executive – selected members of legislature – become ministers
- Presidential democracy
 - This form – executive – independent of legislature
 - President – elected by people – no need – confidence of legislature – his/her position
 - Some countries – India – states – own govt. – not completely independent – governed by larger national govt. – Union govt.
- Diff. forms – democratic govt. – diff. structure

Institution	Executive	Legislature	Judiciary
India	Prime minster and the council of ministers	Lower House (Lok Sabha) – more powerful than – Upper House (Rajya Sabha)	Independent from executive and legislature (separation of power)
USA	President	Equal power – Upper House (Senate) and Lower House (House of representatives)	Independent from executive and legislature (separation of power)
South Korea	President	Single house (National Assembly)	Independent from executive and legislature (separation of power)
Australia	Prime minster and council of ministers	Equal power – Upper House (Senate) and Lower House (House of representatives)	Independent from executive and legislature (separation of power)

What do these terms mean?

- **Executive** – organ of govt. – responsible – implement law – process – election – diff. in diff. countries
- **Legislature** – body of govt. – responsible – making laws – most countries – 2 houses – Upper House, Lower house – diff. names – diff. countries –
 - India – Parliament
 - USA – Congress
- **Upper House and Lower House** – most countries – Lower House – elected – direct voting – more powerful than – Upper House – nomination OR election – houses – diff. names – diff. countries – India – Lower House – Lok Sabha – Upper House – Rajya Sabha
- **Separation of power** – 3 organs – Legislature, Executive, Judiciary – work independently – do not interfere
- Diff. govt. – diff. ways – formation, structures, functioning – also – relation – 3 organs – very diff.
- BUT – some characteristics – equality, freedom, universal adult franchise – remain same – all democracies

A Peek into History

Early republics

- Republic – form of govt. – head of state – elected – not hereditary monarch
- This case – 2 Indian ancient *mahajanapadas*
- Vajji *mahajanapada* – Lichchhavi clan – collective decision-making – leaders chosen – based on merit – not birth
- Key positions – filled – elections – representatives – address issues – regularly – develop solutions
- Result – such states – early republics
- Voice – common people – valued, upheld – through ages – even – power with king, queen
- Remarkable example – Chola period – Uttaramerur inscriptions – 10th cent. CE – Tamil Nadu – provide details – election – members – local *sabha*
- Inscription – teach us – election process – sealed ballot boxes – qualification, duties of members – conditions – dismissal

- Members – immediately removed – found indulged – corruption
- Republics – other parts of world – 5th – 4th cent. BCE – Rome, Greece – republic
- Greece – some regions – free men – vote – BUT – women, workers, slave – no vote
- Other areas – sys. – small grp. – vote, make decisions

Other Forms of Govt.

1. Monarchy

- *Mahajanapadas* – ruled by kings – guided by sabha, samiti – king expected – take decisions, advice – seriously
- Empires – built, expanded – across India – kings gain power – BUT – relied on – council of members – help govern empire
- Many cases – king sought advice – learnt scholars – matters – dharma
- Also, example – kings – used power – oppress people
- Some parts of world – kings – all power – made laws – enforced them – decided punishments
- Some cases – they claimed – received divine power from God
- Many parts – India – power of raja – neither absolute nor beyond question – king expected – make decisions – staying within limits – *rajadharma* – ruling according to dharma – ensuring welfare – all people

Monarchies today

- Monarchy – type of govt. – ruled by monarch – kings, queens – exercise sovereign power
- Monarchies – usually hereditary – eldest son – ruling monarchies – next king
- Today – 2 types of monarchies –
 - **Absolute monarchy**
 - Monarch – complete control – making laws – ensuring enforcements
 - Saudi Arabia – absolute monarchy – king – all powers – governs – Islamic laws
 - Appoints a council – advice, assist – governance – BUT – not bound to advice
 - **Constitutional monarchy**
 - UK (Britain) – monarchy – head of state – king, queen – BUT – nominal power
 - Actual power – executive – prime minister – legislative power – parliament
 - All laws – made by elected parliament – executive power – council of ministers – led by – prime minister
 - Britain – has king – BUT – parliamentary democracy

2. Theocracy

- Form of govt. – country – ruled by – religion, religious leaders
- Iran – Islamic Republic of Iran – unique political sys. – combine elements – both – theocratic, democratic govt.
- Constitution – based on Islamic principles – country's official religion
- Supreme leader – ultimate authority – legislature, executive, judiciary – elected by – grp. – Islamic clerics – term – for life
- Also – elected president, parliament – take care – everyday governance
- Intent – republic – establish society – based on Islamic norms
- Other theocracies – Afghanistan, Vatican City

3. Dictatorship

- Form of govt. – 1 person, grp. of persons – absolute power – no limits imposed – constitution, law
- 20th cent. – many examples – dictators – extremely difficult for people
- Adolf Hitler –
 - Appointed chancellor – 1933 – passed laws – full power – eliminated opposition
 - Now – becomes dictator – convinced – superiority – believed – Germany – rule over world – inferior races
 - Responsible – Holocaust – killing – 6 million Jews – 1000s of Roma, other grps.
 - Reason for World War II – yrs. 1939-1945 – immense loss of life
- Idi Amin –
 - Military dictator – Uganda – responsible – killing – 1000s of people
 - Many Indians – ancestors – migrated to Uganda – forced to flee

Story of Shane

- Shane – live in North Korea – defined rules – everyday living
- Currently – serving – compulsory military service – expected to serve – govt. decides
- Also, rules – hair cut – clothes to wear
- No access – global internet – unaware – outside world
- Govt. – watched his action – closely – also expected – report – anyone – breaks rules
- One day – tourist – asked him – why same hair cut – he replied – govt. decides – hair cut

4. Oligarchy

- Oligarchy – Greek origin – *oligos* – few – *arkho* – to rule, command
- Type of govt. – small, powerful grp. – all decisions – usually – wealthy families, influential people
- Some places – ancient Greece – aristocratic families – ruled as oligarchies
- Modern times – political commentators – obs. – some democracies – signs of oligarchy – small grp. – politician, wealthy businesspeople – too much influence – governance

Why Democracy Matters

- Diff. govt. – democracy – not the only way – countries governed
- Most countries – democracy – considered – better form
- Genuine democracy – people lead everyday life – the way they want
- Democratic govt. – people choose them – this govt. – responsible – basic needs of citizens